$7,500 a year to insure yourself. If your employer offers health insurance, it will only cost you about $1,248 a year. This is why finding a job with good benefits is so important; if you have to pay for health insurance on your own, it can be extremely costly. Therefore, if you need to provide health insurance for your family and Job A offers you $100,000 a year with no benefits, while Job B offers you $85,000 a year with outstanding benefits, choosing Job B may save you more money in the long run.

If health insurance is not covered by your employer (which is common, especially for part-time jobs), that doesn't mean that you are out of luck and have to go uninsured. You can still choose any private health insurance provider you would like, but you will be responsible for covering all of the monthly premiums without help from your employer. If you are in this situation you can visit www.healthcare.gov, a virtual marketplace maintained by the federal government, or a state marketplace, where you can shop for a health insurance plan that fits your needs.

Health Insurance Basics

When you are exploring your health insurance options, these are some of the basic concepts you will need to know about: copay and coinsurance, out-of-pocket maximum, and in-network versus out-of-network.

Copay and coinsurance. A **copay** (or copayment) is a set amount of money that you pay to your medical provider (doctor, dentist, etc.) each time you receive services. If you have a regular checkup, you'll likely pay a copay; if you need to go to urgent care, you'll likely pay a copay; if you need to fill a prescription, you'll likely pay a copay. A typical copay for a routine visit to your doctor ranges